

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

UAC Care Transition Efficiency & Placement Outcome Analytics

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Reporting period: 12 January 2023 – 21 December 2025

Prepared for government and program-management stakeholders

75.03%	2.86%	185.42%	-35.14	-44.74
Transfer Efficiency	Discharge Effectiveness	Pipeline Throughput	Avg. CBP Net Pressure	Avg. HHS Net Pressure

1. Executive Overview

The UAC Care Transition Efficiency & Placement Outcome Analytics project converts aggregate Unaccompanied Children (UAC) program reporting into a process-oriented monitoring framework. Rather than focusing only on the number of children present in CBP custody or HHS care, the analysis examines movement through the care pipeline — transfer and discharge activity, operational pressure, and temporal patterns — to give stakeholders a fuller picture of how the pipeline is performing.

The analysis uses 720 valid reporting observations from 12 January 2023 through 21 December 2025, drawn from a raw dataset of 1,170 rows after removing 450 completely blank records. Across this period the pipeline recorded 67,337 total apprehensions, 92,641 total transfers, and 124,853 total discharges. The resulting dashboard and analytical framework provide a consistent way to monitor CBP-to-HHS transfers, HHS discharge activity, operational pressure, and aggregate pipeline throughput.

2. Key Findings

- Care transitions can be monitored as a pipeline. The analysis separates entry, transfer, and discharge activity so stakeholders can observe where operational pressure may emerge rather than relying only on custody counts.
- Transfer activity is a central operational indicator. The Transfer Efficiency Ratio compares transfers with the number of children in CBP custody for each reporting observation. Across the full study period this ratio averages 75.03%, helping identify periods of relatively stronger or weaker transfer activity.
- Discharge activity provides a second-stage performance signal. The Discharge Effectiveness measure compares discharges with the HHS-care population and averages 2.86% across the study period — an aggregate indicator of discharge activity relative to the reported care population, not an individual outcome rate.
- Aggregate throughput exceeds aggregate inflow. Pipeline Throughput, calculated as total discharges divided by total apprehensions, stands at 185.42% over the study period, reflecting the combined effect of case backlog clearance and discharge activity relative to new apprehensions.

- Pressure can accumulate when incoming activity exceeds outgoing activity. CBP net pressure (apprehensions minus transfers) averages -35.14 per observation, and HHS net pressure (transfers minus discharges) averages -44.74. Both averages are negative, indicating outgoing activity has kept pace with or exceeded inflow on average, though sustained positive pressure in individual periods still warrants closer operational review.
- Operational patterns vary over time. Monthly, yearly, and weekday analyses reveal changes in transfer and discharge activity and help identify periods that may require additional management attention.

3. Management Implications

The dashboard can support program managers by bringing the main stages of the care transition process into a single monitoring view. A combined view of transfer efficiency, discharge activity, pipeline throughput, and operational pressure can help prioritize periods for deeper review.

The analysis also supports a shift from purely capacity-oriented monitoring toward process-oriented performance monitoring. In practice, unusually high CBP pressure, high HHS pressure, or weaker efficiency indicators can be treated as signals for investigation of staffing, transfer capacity, case-management workload, or other operational conditions.

4. Recommended Actions

1. Use the dashboard as a recurring operational monitoring tool for transfer, discharge, and pressure indicators.
2. Review high-pressure reporting periods to determine whether operational constraints or reporting conditions contributed to the observed pattern.
3. Track transfer and discharge indicators together rather than interpreting either stage in isolation.
4. Use monthly and yearly comparisons to identify persistent changes rather than reacting only to individual reporting observations.
5. Improve future data collection by adding timestamps or duration measures so actual transfer and placement processing times can be evaluated.
6. Expand outcome data where available to distinguish aggregate discharge activity from individual sponsor-reunification or placement success.

5. Dashboard Decision Areas

Decision Area	Indicator	Management Use
CBP → HHS transition	Transfer Efficiency	Monitor relative transfer activity and identify periods for review.

Decision Area	Indicator	Management Use
HHS discharge	Discharge Effectiveness	Monitor discharge activity relative to the reported HHS-care population.
End-to-end activity	Pipeline Throughput	Compare aggregate discharges with aggregate apprehensions.
Operational pressure	CBP / HHS Net Pressure	Flag periods where incoming activity exceeds outgoing activity.
Temporal monitoring	Monthly / Yearly trends	Identify persistent changes and recurring operational patterns.

6. Important Interpretation Notes

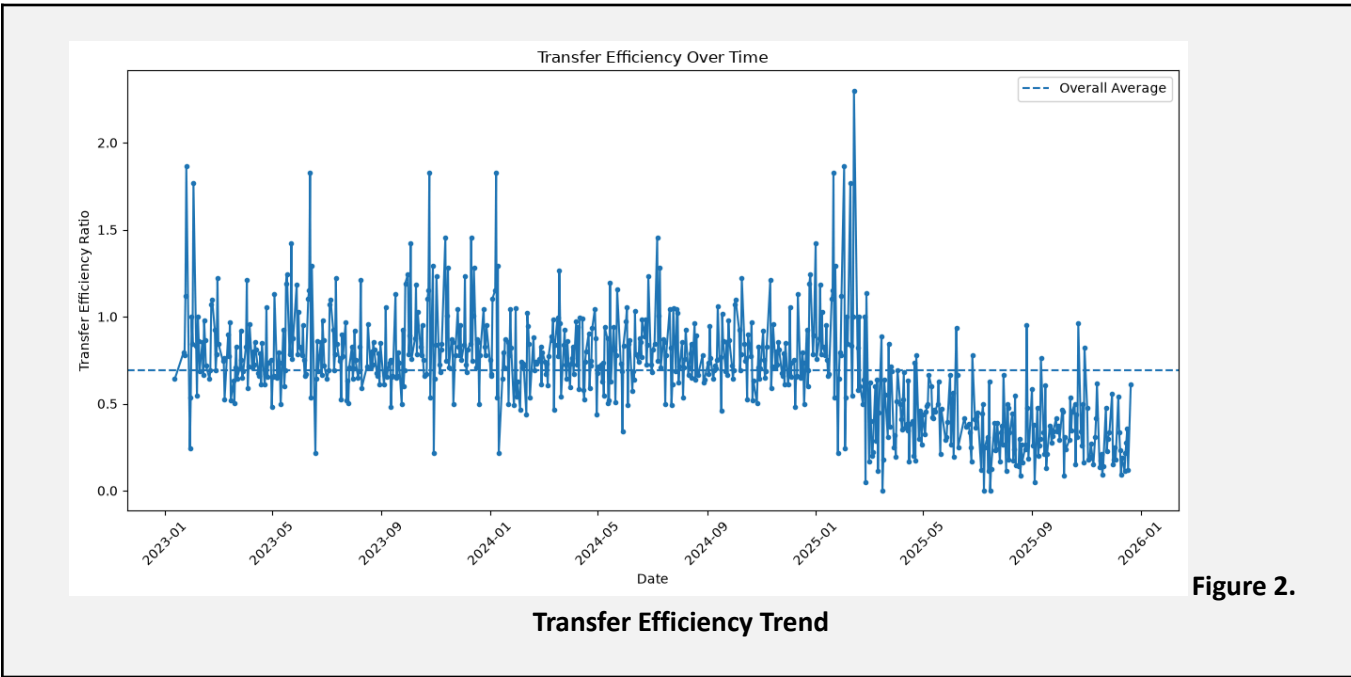
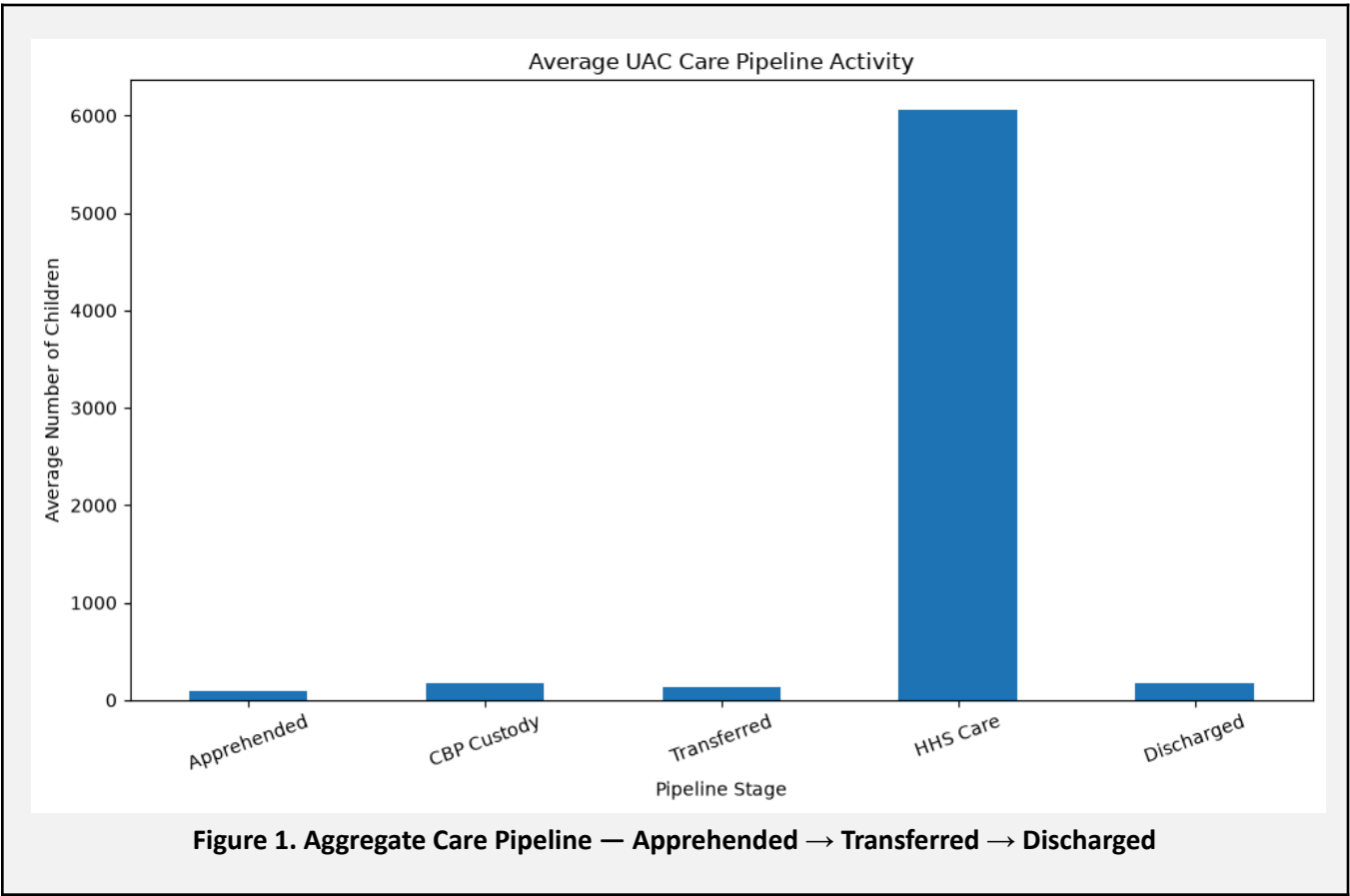
- The efficiency ratios are operational indicators, not direct measurements of elapsed processing time. The dataset does not provide individual-level timestamps linking a child from apprehension through transfer or discharge.
- Discharge activity should not be interpreted as individual reunification success unless additional placement-level outcome data are available.
- Net pressure is an analytical pressure measure. It should not automatically be labeled a literal backlog without confirming the exact stock-and-flow reporting definitions.
- The dataset contains irregular reporting intervals, so missing dates should not be interpreted as zero activity.
- Weekday comparisons should be interpreted cautiously because reporting coverage is uneven across weekdays.

7. Executive Conclusion

The project demonstrates how aggregate UAC program data can be transformed into a practical management framework for monitoring care transitions. The combination of pipeline analysis, efficiency indicators, pressure measures, temporal analysis, and an interactive Streamlit dashboard creates a clearer view of operational performance than custody counts alone.

The strongest next step is to strengthen the underlying data with duration, timestamp, and individual-level outcome fields where appropriate. This would allow future analysis to move from relative operational indicators toward direct measurement of transfer time, placement timelines, and outcome success.

8. Suggested Visuals for Stakeholder Briefing



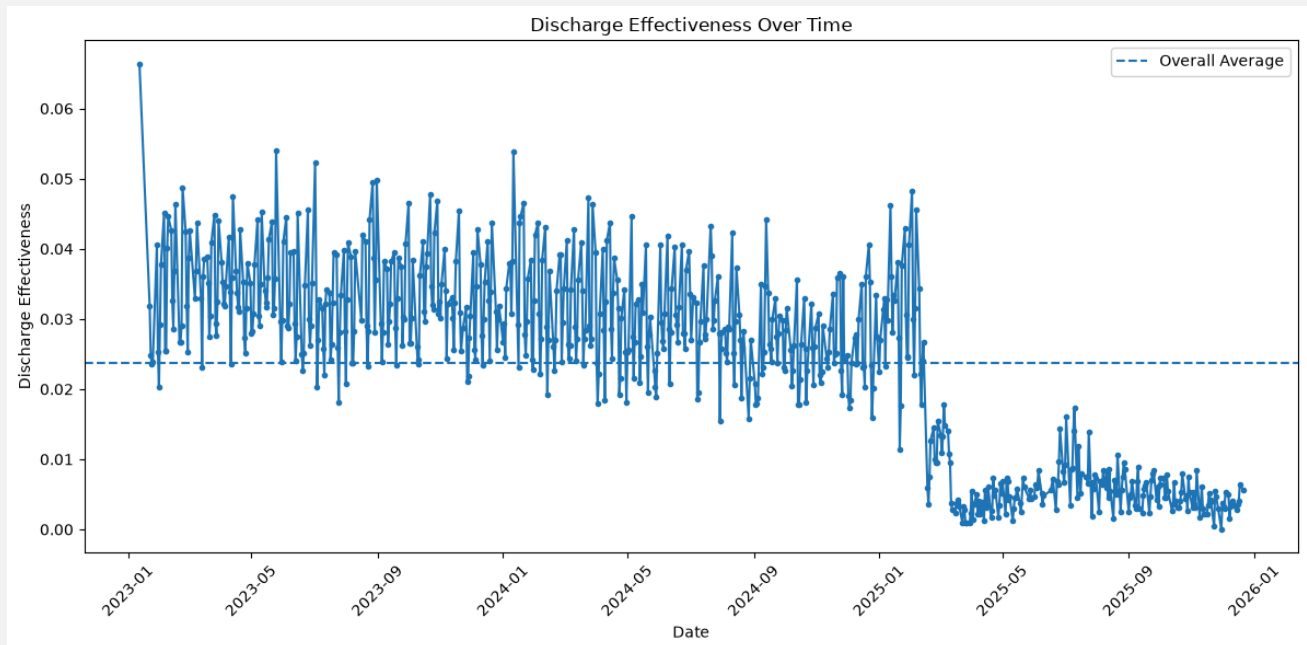


Figure 3. Discharge Effectiveness Trend

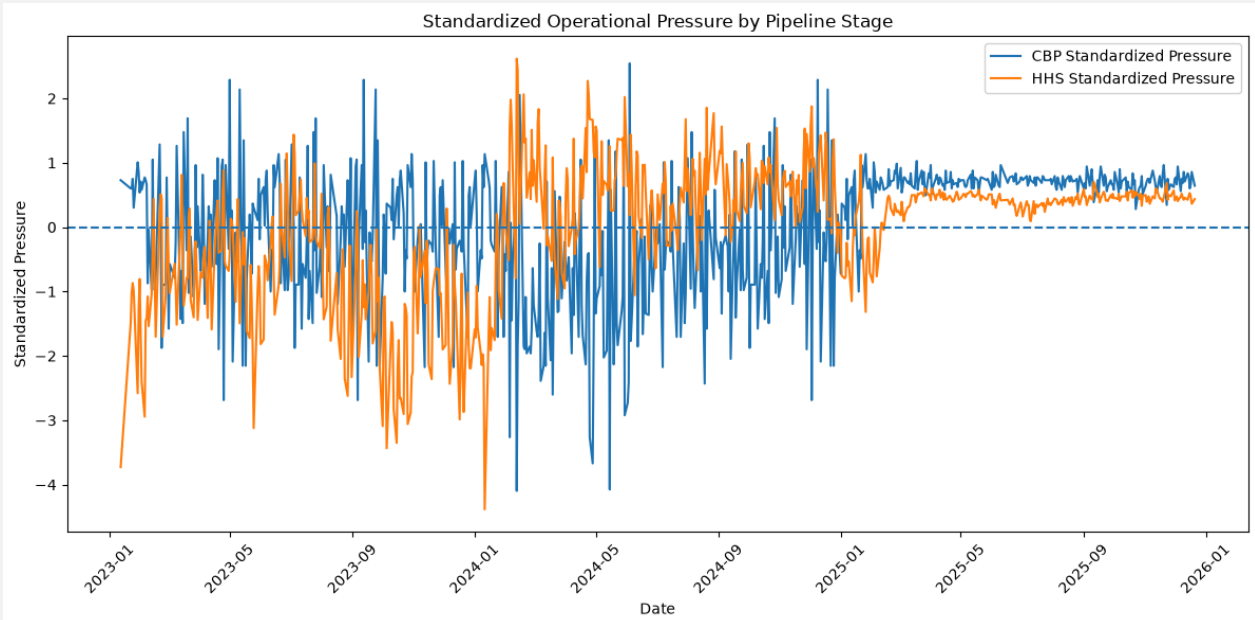


Figure 4. Operational Pressure Over Time

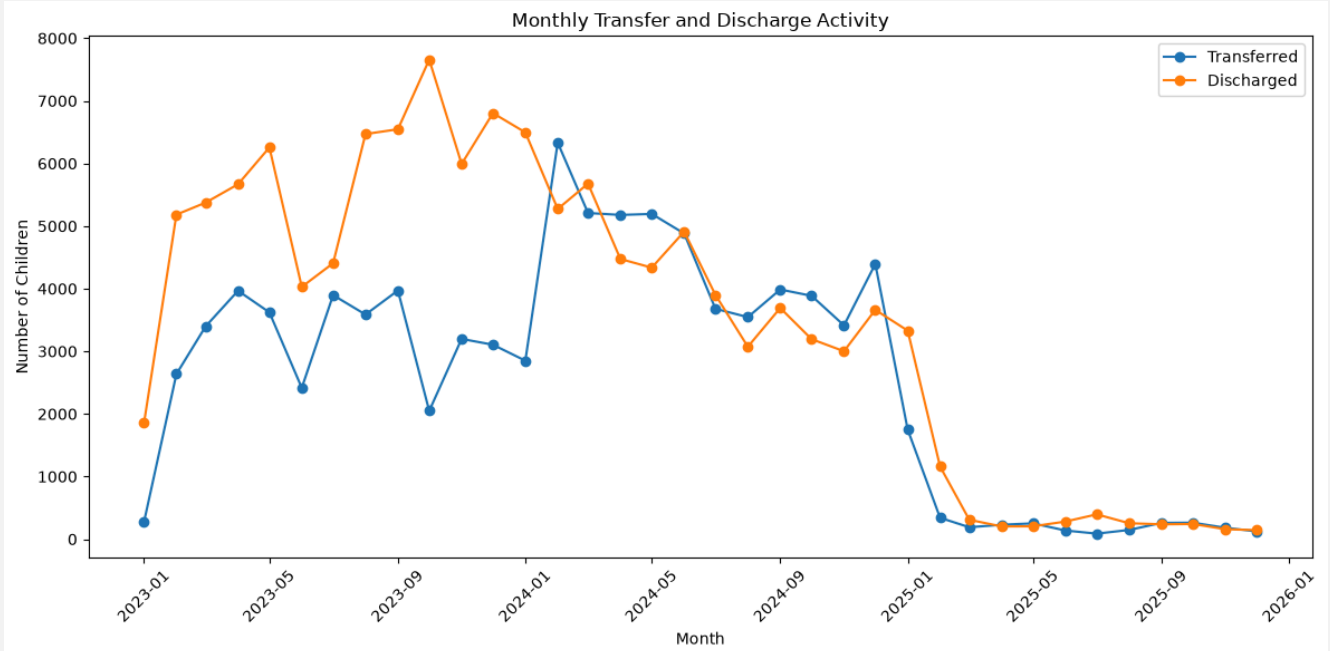


Figure 5. Monthly Transfer–Discharge Gap

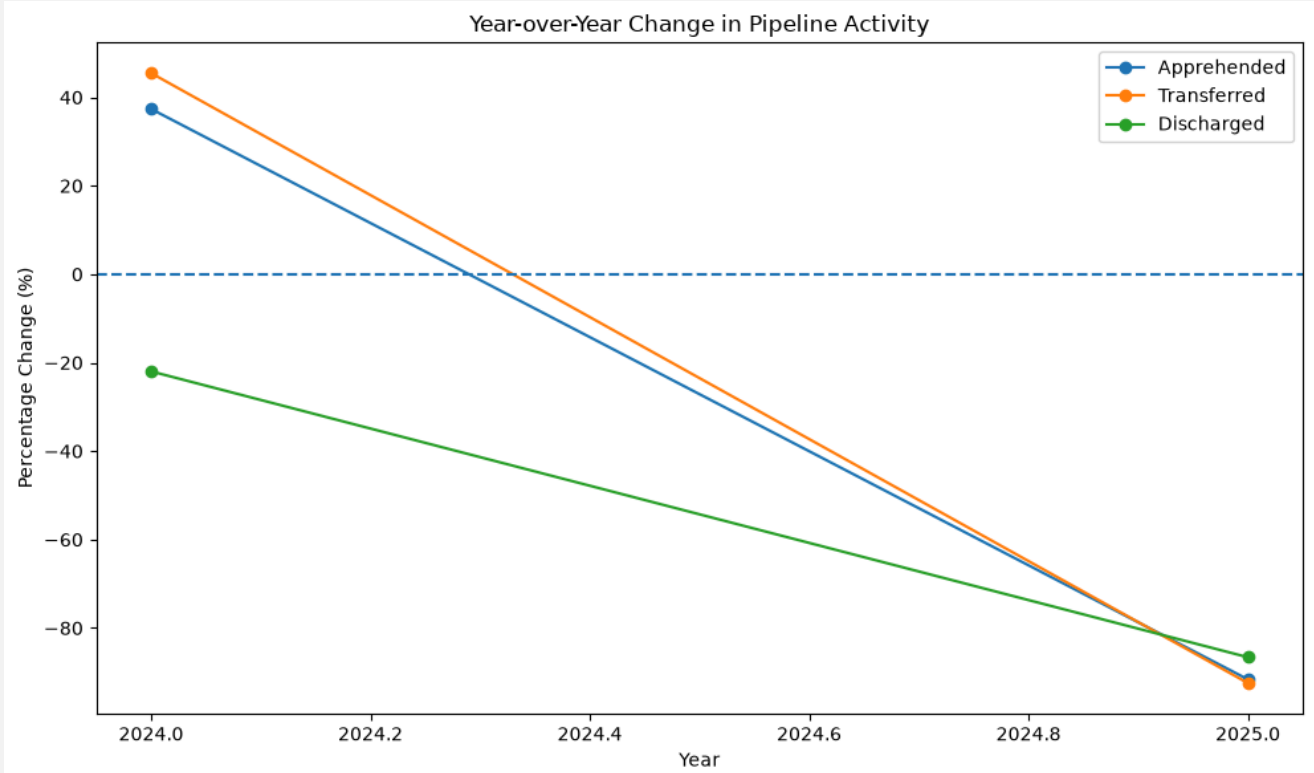


Figure 6. Year-over-Year Transfer and Discharge Activity

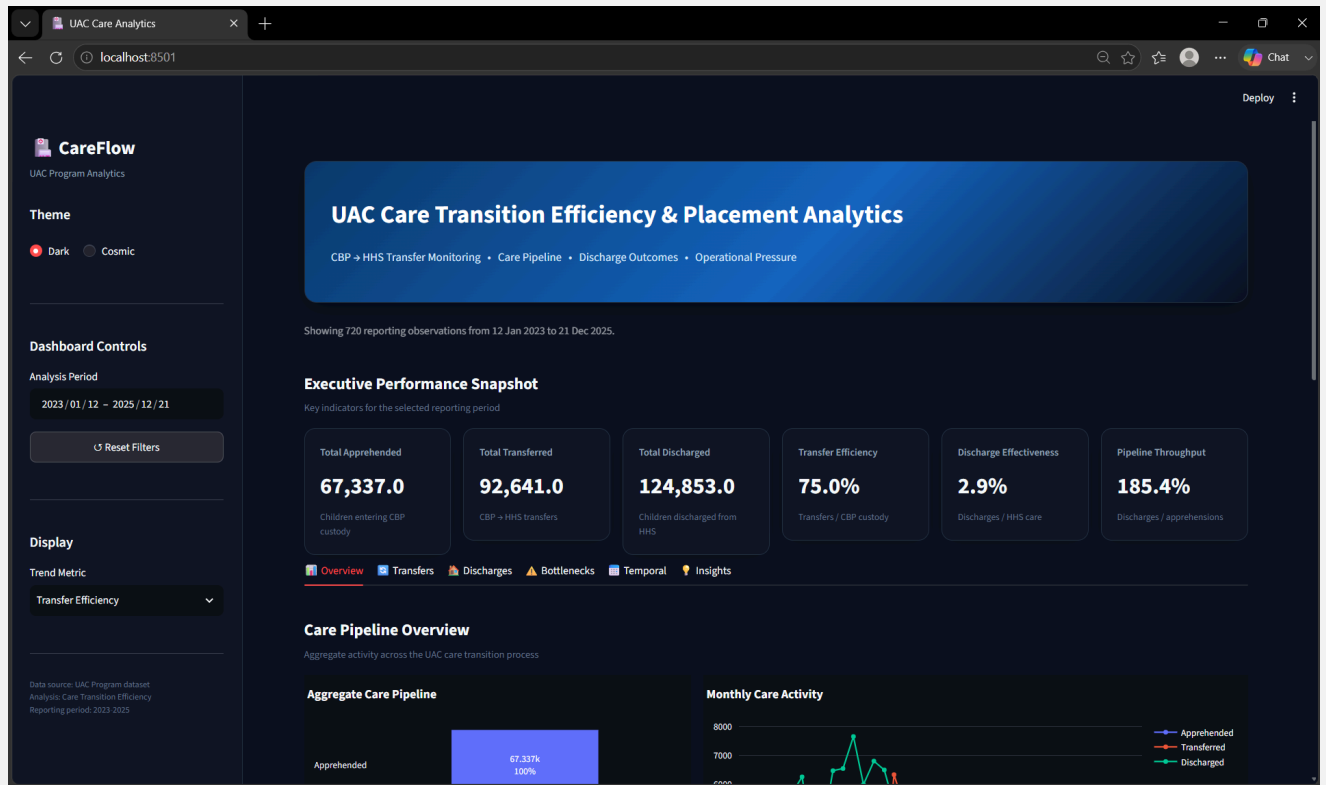


Figure 7. Dashboard Preview